How Much of the Family's Plan for Mom Is Worked Out So Far?

Twelve quick questions about what the family has sorted out. At the end: what's worked out, what's still open, and what to ask next.

Answer yes, no or not sure. This checks how much of the family's plan is worked out. It doesn't measure Mom, or how well anyone is doing at getting ready. A family that has only just started will answer “not sure” to most of these, and that is an ordinary place to start from.

1. Is every idea the family has had about getting ready written on one list?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

2. Has Mom told you, in her own words, what she'd like to get ready and what she'd rather leave alone?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

3. Have you sorted the list into preparation that's useful now and decisions that aren't due?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

4. Can you name the decisions the family is deliberately not making yet?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

5. Do you know which piece of preparation the family would start with, and why that one?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

6. Is there one written list of the things the family doesn't know yet?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

7. For each open question, do you know whether it goes to Mom, her doctor or a care consultant?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

8. Has the family agreed who keeps the planning file?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

9. For each piece of preparation under way, has the person doing it said yes to it themselves?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

10. Is there a day written down for looking at the plan again?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

11. Has the family named the everyday changes that would bring it back to the plan sooner?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

12. Do you know who Mom is happy to have see the plan?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

Answer the questions above and your page builds here.

WHAT'S WORKED OUT

WHAT'S STILL OPEN

WHAT TO ASK NEXT

What this doesn't do

It counts what's been worked out in the plan, not how Mom is doing and not how ready a family ought to be. A short “What's worked out” list means only that some conversations haven't happened yet, and none of them has a date on it.

Ready for the next step?

You can see which parts of the plan are worked out and which are still open. The care interview adds what the plan is measured against: it takes you through Mom's situation as it is today, area by area, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation. Keep the page you just copied beside you while you answer.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›